

BTEC Level 3 Health and Social Care

Unit 2: Working in Health and Social Care

Exam Walkthrough | Paper 31491H | Session: June 2018

How to answer every question · step by step

Command words · what the examiner wants

Identify / State (2 marks) · Give TWO brief, correct points. No explanation needed · just name or state two relevant things. 1 mark per point.

Describe (4 marks) · Give TWO points, each with a little detail. Two developed points = 4 marks (2 marks each).

Explain (6 marks) · Give THREE points, each explained (a point + a reason or effect). Three developed points = 6 marks (2 marks each).

Discuss (8 marks) · Give a BALANCED argument: several developed points PLUS a 'however' counterpoint. Four developed points = 8 marks (2 marks each).

Question 1 (a)

Identify two other health and social care professionals, apart from the GP, who could work with Daniel. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Simple recall of professional roles. Daniel is receiving a support programme, so think of the range of professionals who work with a person needing care · nurses, therapists, social workers.

Model answer:

- District nurse / social worker / physiotherapist / occupational therapist / counsellor (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct professional. Any two valid roles earn the full 2 marks · no explanation needed.

Question 1 (b)

Describe two ways that health and social care staff could work with Daniel's family during his support programme. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two ways staff involve and support the family · involving them in planning, and providing information/emotional support.

Model answer:

- Involving the family in care planning and decisions about Daniel's support.
- Providing information, advice and emotional support to family members.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per way: one for the action, one for the detail. Linking each way to the family's role is what earns the second mark.

Question 1 (c)

Explain how staff could empower Daniel to promote his rights, choices and wellbeing. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Empowerment = giving Daniel control. Think of three ways · involving him in decisions, giving information, and promoting independence/dignity.

Model answer:

- Involving Daniel in decisions about his care and respecting his choices.
- Providing information so Daniel can make informed decisions.
- Promoting Daniel's independence, dignity and confidence.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states an action and its effect on Daniel's rights, choices or wellbeing.

Question 1 (d)

Discuss how personal information about Daniel might be managed by professionals who assess his medical needs. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: This is about confidentiality and data protection. Give three ways information is managed (confidentiality, GDPR/secure storage, consent), then a 'however' about when it must be shared.

Model answer:

- Maintaining confidentiality and only sharing information on a need-to-know basis.
- Following data protection legislation (GDPR) and storing records securely.
- Obtaining Daniel's consent before sharing information with others.
- However, information may need to be shared with the multidisciplinary team or for safeguarding, which must be done lawfully and proportionately.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (lawful sharing for MDT/safeguarding) is the balanced element a Discuss needs.

Question 2 (a)

Identify two ways that hospital staff could support Finn's rights. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Finn is a child with learning disabilities. Think of two ways staff respect his rights · dignity/privacy, and involvement/choice.

Model answer:

- Respecting Finn's dignity and privacy.
- Involving Finn in decisions and offering choice (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct point. Two valid ways to support rights earn the full 2 marks.

Question 2 (b)

Describe two ways that services could support Finn's learning disabilities. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two ways services adapt to support a learning disability · specialist support/communication, and reasonable adjustments.

Model answer:

- Providing specialist support and appropriate communication methods.
- Making reasonable adjustments and adaptations to meet Finn's needs.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per way: one for the support, one for the detail. Be specific about how the support meets Finn's needs.

Question 2 (c)

Explain ways that health and social care workers can promote effective communication for children with learning disabilities. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three communication strategies · using simple language/visual aids, allowing time, and involving family/carers.

Model answer:

- Using simple language, visual aids, Makaton or sign language.
- Allowing time and being patient so the child can respond.
- Involving family or carers who know the child and can support communication.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point gives a strategy and its purpose in aiding communication.

Question 2 (d)

Discuss other possible barriers that service users with a learning disability could face when accessing health and social care services. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three barriers (communication, attitudinal, lack of staff training), then a 'however' about how they can be overcome.

Model answer:

- Communication barriers · difficulty understanding information or expressing needs.
- Attitudinal barriers · discrimination or negative assumptions from staff or others.
- Lack of understanding or training among staff about learning disabilities.
- However, these barriers can be overcome through staff training, reasonable adjustments and accessible information.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (barriers can be overcome) provides the balance a Discuss requires.

Question 3 (a)

Identify two skills required to be a care assistant. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Simple recall of care assistant skills · communication, empathy, patience, observation.

Model answer:

- Communication / empathy / patience / observation (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct skill. Two valid skills earn the full 2 marks.

Question 3 (b)

Describe two ways that an organisation could improve its domiciliary services. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Domiciliary = care at home. Think of two improvements · better staff training, and better communication/coordination.

Model answer:

- Providing better training and development for staff.
- Improving communication and coordination between staff and service users.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per improvement: one for the action, one for the detail. Link each improvement to better service.

Question 3 (c)

Explain how a voluntary organisation, such as Multiple Sclerosis Society UK, can support people with specific needs. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three ways a charity supports people · information/advice, support groups, and campaigning/advocacy.

Model answer:

- Providing information and advice about the condition and available support.
- Offering support groups and peer support to reduce isolation.
- Campaigning and advocating for people's rights, and funding research.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states a support and its benefit to people with the condition.

Question 3 (d)

Discuss ways that health and social care professionals are regulated by professional bodies. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three ways regulation works (standards/codes, registration/revalidation, investigating complaints), then a 'however' about its limitations.

Model answer:

- Setting standards and codes of conduct that professionals must follow.
- Requiring registration and revalidation to maintain competence.
- Investigating complaints and taking disciplinary action where standards are breached.
- However, regulation can be costly and time-consuming, and not all health and social care roles are regulated by a professional body.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (limitations of regulation) provides the balance a Discuss needs.

Question 4 (a)

Identify two other benefits of going to the centre for Della. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Della attends a day centre. Think of two benefits beyond the obvious · social interaction, activities, respite for carers.

Model answer:

- Social interaction / activities / respite for carers (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct benefit. Two valid benefits earn the full 2 marks.

Question 4 (b)

Describe two ways a care assistant could provide for Della's everyday needs. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Everyday needs = personal care and nutrition. Think of two · personal care (washing/dressing) and nutrition/medication.

Model answer:

- Providing personal care such as washing and dressing.
- Supporting nutrition and meals, and helping with medication.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per way: one for the need, one for the detail. Be specific about the everyday need being met.

Question 4 (c)

Explain the responsibilities the manager of the day centre has towards the people who work there. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three duties a manager has to STAFF · safety, training/supervision, and fair treatment.

Model answer:

- Providing a safe working environment and following health and safety legislation.
- Providing training, supervision and support for staff.
- Treating staff fairly and addressing any concerns or grievances.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states a responsibility and its purpose towards staff.

Question 4 (d)

Discuss how investigations into poor working practices have led to improved practices within the health and social care sector. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three ways investigations improve practice (identify failings, new policies, better training/regulation), then a 'however' about the pace of change.

Model answer:

- Investigations identify failings and allow services to learn lessons.
- They lead to new or improved policies and procedures.
- They result in better training and stronger regulation of the sector.
- However, change can be slow and requires resources and sustained commitment from organisations.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (change is slow) provides the balance a Discuss requires.
